

I: Okay, so, I have a little note before we dive into the questions about COVID 19. I just wanted to start by acknowledging that teaching and learning during the pandemic has been a significant disruption in the past months. And for any of the questions I'm about to ask, please feel free to reference, with your normal teaching practices rather than what you're having to do right now to adapt to the crisis. Does that make sense?

UCSB07: Okay, so, yes so, do you want me to tell you whether. So, what are the regular, what is the regular practice that I do without covid during the pandemic and now.

I: You can do either, but if you're able to draw upon what you've done previously more easily because you're not having to face the challenges of trying to teach online that's perfectly fine too. So, whatever touches most relevant to your work.

UCSB07: Okay. That's fine.

I: Alright, so, I'd like to start by hearing about your experience teaching undergraduate students, briefly describe your experience with teaching them, including your current or past research.

UCSB07: so, teaching, the teaching that I've done is mostly on research methods in [field redacted], the students do not necessarily have a background in statistics. I touch upon like basic basic concepts of survey research and sampling and things like that. I tried to teach them more like the general concept and not, and I try not to go through the formula a lot, because there is a lot of uneven students come to the classroom with very different knowledge on the statistics. And so, that is a like, based on that I tried first to level up the ground on using basic concepts and then I go on and teach them a little bit about formulas that are behind but very little, very few.

I: And what are these classes that you're doing the research methods? Can you give me titles of the courses?

UCSB07: So, the title of the course is [course title redacted] and this is an [course level redacted] class that students need to take, this is an obligatory course of a series. They have to choose different methods classes and this is one of them. And in this case, I go over different methods of survey methods. And given that my specialty is in survey research. Half of the course, I teach research and sampling and mostly like history, publishing studies.

I: Sounds like we're having some trouble with that connection again. Yeah, it's breaking a little bit. Okay.

UCSB07: Do you hear me now?

I: I can hear you a little bit better now, so, we'll try. The last thing I heard was about the last class is your teaching work for [course level redacted] undergraduates, they have to choose between two different courses, is that two different courses, about statistics or about research methods you were saying?

UCSB07: Yes, so, there are like about like five or six classes in some methods that teach the students have to choose to take. And one of those methods classes is the one that I teach, which is a survey of method so, we do quantitative and qualitative methods in [field redacted], right here.

I: Alright so, we're going to move on to a section about how your students obtain access to data, so, in your courses, how do your students usually obtain the data they engage with? For example, do they collect or generate the data themselves, or do they search to identify pre-existing data sets, or do you simply provide them with the data sets?

UCSB07: so, in the other undergrad course that I teach, I show them different databases that are available to the social science research. And I asked them to engage with one in particular that is called the General Social Survey. And I asked them to play a little bit with the variables in that survey, and to be able to like to do contingency tables, basically like two by two tables or at most, maybe using three variables. But I provide the data sources, I showed them the resources that are available there. And some of them know them, but most of them, they don't know they don't know all, that all the data is available, we have to show them. And I also ask them to collect some data, they do a little bit of data collection in the survey, when I teach survey methods I ask them to collect some data. But, that is an exercise that I asked them to do in the class.

I: Okay, so, you're mostly providing them with like a pre-existing data set, and maybe having them do a small amount of generating their own data set is that accurate?

UCSB07: Yes. Okay.

I: Can you describe a little bit about what, you've kind of dove into it a little bit with the two table, or the table where there are three variable and there are two tables they are viewing simultaneously. Can you describe that general process a little bit more like what you're asking them to go through when you're having them look at a data set such as that?

UCSB07: Yes, so, the General Social Survey is actually very friendly and then they already provide, their website already provides ways to construct tables. And so, I, what I do is I have TAs and they teach the students how to construct this table so, for example if you want to see. You might either want to see educational level and race and ethnicity. This would be a two by two table. We'd put race in one, in columns and rows educational level for example. So, I asked them to do these kinds of tables to see whether, for example, Hispanics are more likely to have lower levels of education and things like that to see like the relationships among variables. So, I ask them to construct these contingency tables. And, and I usually ask them to choose a topic they're interested in, to construct these tables based on those interests if they want to see the relationships between two or three variables.

I: Okay. So, do you have them, in this case, this is an example of where they're, they're creating their own data set. Is that accurate or is this something where you have given them that data set before they're manipulating it to create the table?

UCSB07: No, no, this is an exercise that they do using a survey that was conducted by, that is out there, called the General Social Survey.

I: Okay.

UCSB07: And the idea is that they, they learn, first of all, how to, how to get access, they will have to have access to these. So, to handle these types of datasets that have a lot of variables. These General Social Surveys have a lot of different variables and they can cross tab these variables and look at the relationships among them. So, they usually choose a topic that they are interested in. And then they choose from the variables that are available, so, I teach them how to navigate on the website of the General Social Survey. How to choose... how to choose the variables. They have to go and see which questions were asked, how the variables were named, and how to construct the tables, cross-tabulations.

I: Okay, that's helpful. Thank you for explaining that. In this scenario where the students are actually creating their own data set, could you describe what that process is like for them.

UCSB07: Yes, what I asked him to do this is, there is a section on survey research. And what I ask them to do first of all is to test, to create a questionnaire the idea is to design and test the questionnaire by conducting about like 10 interviews and to correct the questionnaire because people understand things differently. If the questions are not, are not very clear, people may not understand them so, I ask them first to pilot, to make a pilot of the questionnaire, and once they correct the questionnaire, then they will get, they will interview maybe around like 20 people, not a lot of people this is not like, this is only an exercise of how to design a questionnaire and how to gather data. They might collect, at most, 20 interviews.

I: And then, you mentioned that they're piloting this survey. Is there, I guess a process by which you're having those questions vetted at all? Like, their pilot is that really their way of testing whether or not their questions get to the data that they're seeking, or is there some other like scaffolding you provide them before that pilot.

UCSB07: No Well, the idea is for, for them to realize that sometimes we think that our question is very clear and everyone is understanding the question in the same way. And when you go out to the field and you start to ask that question then you realize that your question is too long or the question is understood in very different ways that you are capturing other stuff that is not the one thing that you want to capture the concept that you want to capture it's more like, how do you operate operationalize that concept in a way that is reliable. That is the exercise.

I: Sure. Okay, great. In these scenarios both where you're providing them with the data sets and those when they're constructing their own, what have you found to be the greatest challenges and, and the one side finding the data sets for your teaching and then the other, you know, having them generate it. What's the biggest challenges with both of those?

UCSB07: I guess, these, these exercises are complimentary. So, the first one, the first one requires skills of how to handle databases. So, the first one requires, the first one is designed for them to learn how a questionnaire looks, how those questions are coded in different ways, like how the coding is done. And then how you can recode those variables in order to be able to create a table or answer the question that you want to answer. So, it's more like on the side of using data that is available, and learn a little bit about how from a question you translate that into codes, and do the

coding, then you translate that into a statistical analysis. So, that is the first approach right when we look at secondary data. And in the case of survey research, where they are collecting data, my focus is more on how to do a questionnaire, how to write a question that is reliable, so, the exercise is more on the survey design and how we can get questions that are basically valid. And it's different, the exercises are complimentary, so, one has one objective and another has another objective. And so, the challenges are different so, the challenges in the first one, are more like technical challenges. Because they need to get into the website, learn how to use the website, learn how to read like how the variables are constructed, learn, they learn a bunch of skills about the data, how to manage data. And that is challenging, in the sense that sometimes they don't know how to navigate the websites. It applies technical skills, and then statistical skills, because they have to create a table and be able to read it. So, that is more like, the challenge is to like teach them how to do, to learn statistical tools but also data management tools, skills, and the other, the other exercise the challenges. The challenge, right now, during covid is that they will have to do this with only the people they know so, that they can be safe and all that. But before they had to go outside and I think that it's less challenging because it requires listening skills. And they realize that people respond by understanding the questions they have to reframe the question. It is more like the process, learning process in the field that is more natural and it requires less technical skills, I guess.

I: Okay. So, we had a little bit of a glitch in the last response. I just wanna make sure I captured your response to that. The other side when they're out there in the field their greatest challenge right now you said with covid is that they can really only realistically ask people they know, for the sake of being safe. But before then, could you kind of repeat that a little bit just because we had your, your audio cut out just a tad.

UCSB07: Now before they, they just go like usually the final tests that they do to conduct the same in the same university or in the inner neighborhood. So, the pilots they conduct with people they know and then when they collect the data they try to find people that are the appropriate sample that they want to target, because they are interested in that specific problem. So, they will need to go out and find the right people, that is, the people that are interested in surfing, before they could do that. Now it's more difficult.

I: Right, right. I would imagine so. The next set of questions is more specifically to do with when students are actively working with the data. And in this question, we're looking for what kinds of tools or software you're having students use, for example Excel or online platforms, or any analysis visualization tools.

UCSB07: Yes, for undergrads because they, it's very uneven, the levels we have when they come to my class. What I teach them in class is to use a platform that is already available online. Which is basically, I, I use the General Social Survey as the main platform in the class, I don't use any statistical package or, I don't teach them how to code because that would be very difficult for a class like this, because it's a survey of methods. I go over different kinds of methods that are quantitative and qualitative in one quarter, so, I cannot devote a lot of time like in programming and doing a statistical analysis. So, I basically devote like maybe, I don't know maybe like five weeks to survey research and measurement and all that but to analyze data I devote maybe like three classes, and that then data analysis. And so, the, the, the way that I do it is I provide like this, in class I show them how to read cross tabulation. Basically, what is that dependent and independent variable and my

TAs in their sections go over how to use specifically this platform that is for the data that I use the General Social Survey, they have this online platform where you can create tables, like once you choose the variables that you're going to use, you create the tables and you can also create graphs, so, you, they have like these two things that you can create and this is the thing that they have to provide. In one of the exercises that they do for my class, they have to answer one research question that they have, and they have to tell me, which are the variables that are involved, and how, and they have to provide that graph. And sometimes I ask them, well, I ask them to try to replicate the graph that these websites produce. I ask them to replicate it in Excel. That is very sometimes very challenging for them. Many of them don't know how to create a graph in Excel.

I: so, just to clarify, earlier with the survey you were having them do, is the idea with the compilation of data with that survey that they have some quantitative data, as well as qualitative or is it dependent upon their topic?

UCSB07: So, when they do the survey, when they're collecting the data, it's more, the exercise is more focused on survey design and questionnaire design, it's less about analyzing the data. It's more like piloting a questionnaire and designing questions that are reliable.

I: Sure. And then just to follow up on the platform you're describing, did you provide... What is the name of it, just called the general social science?

UCSB07: Yeah, the name, the name of the service General Social Survey.

I: General Social Survey. Okay, great.

UCSB07: And the test, it is a representative sample of the US, and they have information for every year like since a long time ago. So, actually, they can see changes like because it changes for a period of time, it's, it's a very interesting subject because it has many topics, included.

I: Okay, great. So, you kind of have addressed this a little bit already in the very early part of our conversation but what prior knowledge of the tools or the software do you expect students to have and then which do you teach to them explicitly?

UCSB07: Most of them, they don't know how to use the General Social Survey. Not all the students have, most of the students do not have experience with data sources like these. So, I start from scratch, I show them what is the question, how you download the questionnaire. Then I teach them how to do that. They need to know this is a representative sample, what is the population frame, then I go over the website and show them how to find variables based on the question or the questions, they are interested in how to read the tables, I go over all those things from scratch.

I: And then in terms of, you mentioned that they, in one exercise you've asked them to kind of recreate a graph that's in this platform using Excel so, do you kind of expect that they have some familiarity with Excel?

UCSB07: Yes. Yeah, but I know now that many of them don't know how to use it. And sometimes I ask that they have to do that because the graph that the platform provides sometimes has

categories that shouldn't be there, based on the research question that my students have. So, they would have to redo the graph. Basically, because they will have to get rid of one category or something, based on the research question so, they will have to redo the graph. And also, because presenting graphs in Excel sometimes they look better. So, the presentation is improved, if you know how to do it, like in Excel you have the flexibility to do it. Perhaps they are better formatted, you can have more flexibility. But they don't know, like many of them, they don't know how to use Excel so, I have to provide examples of how to use it, and I basically do that in the sections like the TAs are the ones that show them how to use Excel, how to improve the graphs and the tables.

I: Okay. Are there other tools that you're having them engage with that you find yourself having to teach too in those sections or mostly is it Excel and then this General Social Survey?

UCSB07: Well, I have changed over time like this is the last iteration of it. Yeah, the last iteration. At the beginning I thought I could show them a little bit of programming and that didn't work. Obviously because you need much more time to do that so, I changed it. And now I found this platform and I think this is ideal because you can at least show them the basic concepts of a survey, how it works, how it is coded and how you can use actual data in order to be able to read a table.

I: So, I think I might know the answer to this next question but I'm going to ask it anyway. To what extent are the tools or software students use to work with data important for your teaching.

UCSB07: Well for this class in particular because it's a survey of methods. You don't have to go deeper into using data. It would be great if the students could already know how to program, how to use statistical packages. But I think that for the purposes and the goals of this particular class because it's a survey of methods that will not be necessary. But for other classes, for other methods classes that require more, like for example if there are just a lot of classes that are only survey research. It would be very useful for us as teachers if students already knew a little bit of coding, even if they knew a little bit of Excel. But, for example, with Excel, it seems to me that that would be very, very useful if they knew of any of those things.

I: And then, do you face any challenges related to the students abilities working with data in your classes?

UCSB07: I think they are not very experienced in using data, I think that, I don't know maybe it's because it's [field redacted] and people think that in [field redacted], you will not be required to do these kinds of things like data analysis. Most of the people, of the students that go to [field redacted] at UCSB, they are more, they want to do more qualitative than quantitative work. And so, I think that it's also like the profile of the students that they don't, they're not looking to do quantitative work. When they choose [field redacted], they don't know that actually [field redacted] includes a bunch of like, half of sociologists do quantitative work.

I: Sure

UCSB07: But probably they don't know that and one of the problems that I think that I've come to realize is that this shouldn't be an upper division class, it should be a lower division class, so, that people can choose how come they then the students are more aware of all the possibilities that [field redacted]

redacted] has like it's not only qualitative work, we do a lot of quantitative work. And if they have that since the beginning they would have known that you can do this and that -

I: It looks like we've had a little glitch in our audio again. Are you still there?

UCSB07: Hey there. Yes.

I: Hi. I lost your last bit there but you know if it's, rather than trying to have you repeat it because you were kind of leading into what related to what my next question is do you mind if we move on to that one because that way you can elaborate more on what you were just saying?

UCSB07: Yes

I: so, this question is about how do the ways in which you teach with data relate to the larger learning goals of your field and the last piece I had heard was students that come into [field redacted] at UCSB tend to think you primarily work with qualitative data but that there's this whole other branch of [field redacted] that specifically deals with quantitative so, maybe if you could elaborate a little bit more on how the learning goals in your field kind of relate to the, what you're teaching in this class.

UCSB07: Yes. So, what I was telling you is that this class that I'm teaching, I think should be a lower division class instead of an upper division class. Because when you have freshmen and then you show them like the different methods and how these different methods answer different questions they might be exposed early enough to start to be interested in looking at taking more statistical classes, or other quantitative methods classes. But the problem is that they, they - Sorry, I'm in my house and I have to move, I am out of breath right now, haha.

I: Totally Okay

UCSB07: So, so, I think that they need to be exposed early on in their careers to all the options that they have, because if they do it the way that it is right now, they just, they don't take the courses that need to be taken in order to be able to understand better statistical methods in here.

I: And I just want to make sure that also to go back to this question about the ways that you're teaching data represents the learning goals in your field and that's part of what you're trying to express I think here right is that by exposing them to this earlier, kind of, it's a better representation of what people in [field redacted] are studying and how they go about conducting their work, is that right?

UCSB07: Yes, because right now it's, everything has a certain degree of bias towards qualitative methods and qualitative methods are geared to answer some questions but not all, and [field redacted] includes a bunch of other things that are related to the population studies and quantitative methods and other questions that you also want to know about social structure and how social structure has an influence in individual behaviors. And so, quantitative methods are better suited to answer those questions but students, because they don't take, I think, the methods classes early on,

they don't realize that they can take other classes and statistical classes to be able to do these other kinds of [field redacted] that is out there.

I: Okay. So, this is a little bit of a change of course, how do you teach your students to think critically about the sources and uses of data they encounter in everyday life?

UCSB07: Right now I'm personally trying to... I've been trying to redesign this course so, much so, that they are interested, and they can see the usefulness of learning these types of methods in their own lives. When they read for example, when they get their news from the newspaper when they see the news on TV like I try to, right now I'm trying to incorporate more examples of everyday life, like everyday news. What are their interests, what are their opinions and I try to compare those opinions, what are the sources of their opinions. And then, how would they create a study where you can actually test those ideas and then I come across with studies that are already done conducted using quantitative methods for example, to answer those questions so, that they can see that their opinion, maybe like bias towards their experiences or what is in the news and at the end, the way we are scientists, answer questions. Following these methods, in particular quantitative methods, may change our opinion of how something works because they are able to compare their own opinion at the beginning. So, I try to ask them what is your opinion about this topic at the beginning of the class. And then we go through the whole lesson and then I show them a paper about that question. And then they compare what was their opinion, and what does a study well conducted say about that phenomena. And they can compare. So, that is one way that I'm doing it.

I: Nice. And then how do you teach, or do you teach students specific data skills that will prepare them for future careers?

UCSB07: Statistical skills, so, this class in particular is not designed for that. Like, at most, what I can do is to tell them okay if you are exposed to, if you read in the newspaper or if you are exposed to...

Well, if you see a table to answer one specific question. What are the things that you need to ask yourself in order to know their study is well conducted? You know if you listen, if you read the newspaper, how can you know that the study where this is based from or this opinion or whatever, how do you know what this data represents? so, that's the goal of the class. This is not a class where they learn how to manipulate data.

I: Back to that notion of being a survey class more so, than, you know, targeted towards a specific research method design principle.

UCSB07: It's more like if you hear a news story, if you see a study like, what does that data represent? Or if you hear or post a survey, how are they conducted, what are they saying, what is the scope of the study? Like those things are the things that I asked them to do, because they hear that this is a survey and they believe everything that the survey is saying but at the same time they say well what is what is the population frame. What does this data represent? Is representative of what and things like that. There's a lot of attrition in the data like is this representative or not, there's a lot of mortality. What does this represent? That is what all the time I'm asking them to do when they are looking at data.

I: Right. Yeah. Have you observed any policy or cultural changes at our institution that influenced the way you teach with data?

UCSB07: At our institution, I don't think so. No, no, no, no. Right now I will try to push, just for example like to try to do this class instead of upper division, lower division because I think that is important. I will push for that. But changes, no. I've been trying to, in our department for example, most of the department is qualitative. And we have very, very few quantitative researchers as members of the faculty. Faculty members are very, very few quantitative and that has been also a problem because we need more. In order to be able to be stronger in quantitative methods in [field redacted] here, and to be able to get more students that are quantitative that want to do quantitative work you need more faculty that does quantitative work. Because if not, you are signaling that this is a qualitative department. And so, people that want to do qualitative work come here but we never have students, for example, that want to come to UCSB because we are very, very, like, around [number range redacted] members that do quantitative research. It's very, very small. And it would be great if there was, like, maybe like with the previous Dean, he wanted to hire more specifically people that do quantitative research. And now that is gone. So, it would be great to have more people doing quantitative research in this department and I think that would help.

I: Okay, so, then do the instructors in your field face any ethical challenges in teaching with data?

UCSB07: Ethical challenges, teaching with data.

I: Specifically, like you were mentioning, I mean this isn't, not an ethical challenge but your other challenge of not having enough representation in the department about quantitative [field redacted] research but any other ethical orientations or challenges with teaching with the data?

UCSB07: With teaching, well, all the data that I use in class is data that is publicly available. When they collect the data they do it anonymously and I ask them to do the IRB training. To all my students I asked them to do that when they go to the field to pilot the questions. Basically, those surveys are anonymous. That is not a problem. So, I think in that sense there is nothing, not that could be problematic. They basically do those pilots at the university and when they go out to see more specific populations that they are interested in, they are interested in, they have different interests. But I ask them to collect information in an anonymous way, and to get informed consent. So, all the protocols that we need in order to get data. But it's more like an exercise, they don't gather a lot of data like that.

I: Thank you. So, our next section is on training and support and I'm just cognizant of the time it's 12:44 so, I think it'll be about 15 more minutes if that works for you.

UCSB07: Yes.

I: so, in your course does anyone other than you provide instruction or support which it sounds like in this case you have TAs. And for those people, obtaining or working with data, for example, the co-instructors, teaching assistants, or even librarians. How does their instructional support relate to the rest of the course, so, maybe just describing a little bit of how the structure of the course runs with these TAs.

UCSB07: Yeah, so, basically the TAs. So, the first part of the course, I ask them to teach the students how to learn basically the platform of the General Social Survey. So, first of all the TAs help me to define the research questions. I divide my class in different groups that work together, of maybe pairs or three, or groups of three. And the TAs are in charge of, first of all, helping them define our research question. And based on the questionnaires that are available in the General Social Survey so, they helped me first teaching the students how to navigate the website of the General Social Survey. In order to be able to see the questionnaire first, so, the topics that are available there. And then they kind of like put students into groups of students based on their interests. And then the students will develop a research question using the help of the TAs. And then they will, the TAs will help them navigate the website in order to be able to find the variables and to be able to produce tables, so, that will be like the first thing. The TAs help me do that, like all the training using the website and defining the research question. Then for the survey research design, they also help the students. But that is more on the part of the students so, only if the students have questions, they will ask the TAs but they will only go over the main concepts of how to design a survey, know the specific ways that you need to frame questions in order to avoid answers that are not understood. To avoid different meanings in one question. So, there are like specific rules that you have to follow. And so, they will go over that. And then, the students will do the pilot and they will change the survey, depending on the results. And the TAs will also help me so, in the qualitative part of the course, but this is not related with the quantitative methods, it's more like in depth interviews and things like that.

I: I see, OK, and then how do you go about communicating with them for the instruction they provide.

UCSB07: Yeah, this is something that has changed over time.

I: Right. Feel free to refer to both obviously because I know what you're doing now is likely very different from how it was before March.

UCSB07: I mean, I've been changing that a lot. I have been teaching this class now for three years and the class looks very different than it did at the beginning. So, my communication with the TAs, I basically teach them because they don't know how to use the General Social Survey, so, I show them how to use this General Social Survey. I ask them specifically what I want from students to do. So, all the things they teach to the students, I will teach to the TAs.

I: Okay. And then throughout the quarter, how does that communication change after you've done the initial, kind of preparing them?

UCSB07: so, it depends also on the TA, some kids are more independent but I usually like to talk to them and ask them. So, what are the issues with the students, if they are understanding the material. And over the years, what I've changed is that I'm like, I have to be more clear and give more clear expectations of the exercises. So, I'm like, okay, if you produce a table, you need to include... I have to be super specific. You need a paragraph showing what is the specific relation between these two variables. I have to develop rubrics, like very clear rubrics, so, that the TAs know specifically what I'm looking for and they can clearly convey that to the students so, that there are

not misunderstandings. And I think that that has helped a lot. So, once they know exactly what I want and how to grade, and all that, then, that works better for the students.

I: Great. And then to your knowledge, is there any, I guess formal training or informal training that these students are doing outside of the, you know, help that you've given them to learn how to work with data for this course.

UCSB07: Um, I don't think that for this course they require that but some students struggle more than others for sure. Some students, and that is a problem with this course like some students really, really, really know like the basic concepts in statistics so, average median, mode and all those things they think they know. And, and sometimes I have to go over those concepts, those are very basic because they don't know. So, the field is not very well. It's not plain. It's like you have people at very different levels. And it's a little bit hard to be done so, that everyone is happy like people like I need to go to the very, very basics. And some of them, some of them require more help outside and they actually go with the TAs and ask for help.

I: Okay. Do you expect or encourage any kind of extra curricular learning in that case when there's folks that maybe need a little bit more education in order to teach the concepts in your course.

UCSB07: Actually what I've been developing right now. Now with the coronavirus and I think that it's been very useful. I've developed for example, many videos on how to use Excel, and then I go, this is the way Excel works. And this is the way you produce a graph and I'm telling you, I am doing like mini videos so, that they can see how I'm creating those graphs, for example. I think those are very useful because they can watch them whenever they want. And they can just basically copy the exercise that I'm doing. And then they realize okay so, this is the way you do the graph, for example. I was like mini videos like that that are like, okay, how can you do this specific graph or how can you format a table in Excel, those can like, help them, you know, to be able to understand better how to use Excel how to learn how to use Excel how to bring us like better graphs or something like that. For my course because it's a survey of methods, I wouldn't say that they need like a bunch of stuff, but for other courses like survey research or courses where the idea is to use data, they would need a lot more resources.

I: Okay, great. Those videos sound like they'll be very helpful going forward for you.

UCSB07: Yeah, right now I'm actually thinking of changing. Well, it will change because now it's going to be an online hybrid course. I think that for the following term when there's no coronavirus, I will still rely on that course because I think that the use of my time in person might be better if I do more exercise and applied work. And maybe they can see the lecture online. I don't know, I'm thinking of changing it.

I: Oh sure, like the flipped approach like where they kind of prepare for the session, the session ahead of time, and then they come in that they're able to actively work through some of these exercises with you there.

UCSB07: Yeah, I'm thinking of doing that.

I: Interesting. So, this is the last section related to your own training. So, have you received training and teaching with data, other than your graduate degree. Examples would include workshops or technical support or even help from your peers.

UCSB07: Teaching with data. Well, I just took, not specifically with data, I haven't taken a lot of courses here at UCSB in instructional development of how to teach, pedagogical strategies. So, I took in the summer through the [conference name redacted] offered to develop courses online, but it wasn't much more than that. It was also like the strategies to like to be more focused on our pedagogy, to be more focused on the concepts that we really want to convey and to be more clear when producing rubrics and that kind of stuff and so, I've been taking those, not specifically for data. But I've also been teaching the other statistics course for grad students. And so, over the course I've been developing different strategies and teaching them how to program and these are grad students that really don't know, they also lack a lot of knowledge of basic statistics. They don't know how to program. They require a lot, they need a lot of resources in order to be able to take these classes and these are the basic statistics classes for grad students. So, no, I haven't. I haven't had any training, specifically on data, like, how to teach data courses or quantitative courses. I've been doing that and I've been changing and changing and changing.

I: Right.

UCSB07: Based on the level of the students. With the pandemic it has been, it has been a little bit challenging.

I: Sure. And then, for any of the data sets that you use or assign, how do you share any of these instructional resources that you have or have you received from others before.

UCSB07: How do I share them with students?

I: No, this is more along lines of sharing your instructional resources from others who teach, I believe.

UCSB07: How do I use other resources?

I: One second. Let me look at this question again so, it says do you use any data sets, assignments, plans, syllabi, or other instructional resources that you've received from others, and then do you make your own resources available to others? I think the idea behind this question is like fellow instructors who may teach similar courses. Is there any kind of cross collaboration, like here's the materials that I used to help students learn how to develop a survey and then pilot that survey.

UCSB07: Yeah, absolutely. A lot of sharing.

I: Could you describe it? How do you go about doing that, I suppose, is it just within UCSB or is it outside UCSB?

UCSB07: Yeah so, many of my colleagues, I studied grad school at [institution name redacted] so, we share like, we do a lot of methods classes. Actually like most of my classmates at [institution

name redacted] when I was a grad student, now they are professors at different universities and they teach the methods class, so, we share the way that we are teaching and then we kind of like, change it and adapt it to our university and our knowledge and also to the topics that we really that we know. It's not the same class but we share the strategies that we use. And that is something that always happens. We are asking for how are you teaching this or what do you recommend? And we actually for example in Facebook, sometimes we ask like I'm looking for something interesting for my class for my students to learn this concept, do you have something, and then someone will post, yes, I have these I have used these. So, sometimes we are, we're sharing all the time.

I: Sounds like a great community of practice.

UCSB07: Yes, and also from my previous instructors like the classes that I took at [institution name redacted]. So, they had incredible instructors there, and teachers and so, I use their syllabi and then I adapt. Also I take from different, so, I use different syllabi from them and they create my own.

I: Nice. Okay, we're getting close. Considering the evolving trends in your field, what types of training or assistance would be most beneficial to instructors who are teaching with data like yourself?

UCSB07: What will be more beneficial for me?

I: Considering the evolving trends in the field, are there specific types of training out there that you think would be beneficial to teachers like you?

UCSB07: Oh, yes, yes, yes, yes. A lot! Well, yeah, for example, so, there are different methodologies, statistical methodologies that I would like to learn how to implement and there are new ways of implementing those. Using new programs like, for example, R or STATA and I would like to learn those but those are super expensive and I can't afford to take those courses. Those courses would, like it would be great if we could get money to get into those courses easily. Or easier, get someone here to teach us or whatever, like, that would be great. Right now, I am part of the [name of organization redacted] at UCSB, and so, we ask some students to teach some like basic courses on R. And we as faculty, not all the faculty knows R and R is like something that is free, it is a software that is available for free and that might be very useful for students because they don't have to pay any license. But for, example, I don't, I don't use it I would like to learn it. So, trainings like that would be incredible for us to continue our training, and also to be able to train our students in these more affordable and software that are available and also more powerful.

I: Okay, great. And last, but not least, is there anything else from your experience or perspective as an instructor on the topic of teaching with data that you'd like to share.

UCSB07: I don't know, I think that I already talked a lot.

I: It was a very, very rich conversation so, I really appreciate your time sharing what you have, happy to hear more if you had anything else that popped in.

UCSB07: No, I think one of the challenges and this, this has been something very useful right now, I took the [conference name redacted] and they gave fellowships to the people that took the course in

order to develop our courses and we got money. I've been able to hire a grad student and an undergrad and actually I'm redesigning my methods classes so, that it is more interesting. I want to make the topics more interesting for the students. So, before, because my specialty is in [research topic redacted]. My class was very focused on [research topic redacted] and I think a lot of students were not interested. So, right now I'm looking for new topics that are more exciting for them, like for example, marriage markets and dating, and maybe gender privilege and white privilege and things like that. That are about the US, I'm trying to focus on the US and how you can answer questions using data based on these topics that are of interest for, I think, for them. And once I defined the topics that I want, I've been asking that my grad student and my undergrad are helping me to find some material, and that has been really useful. And now that you are asking, this is like taking over the previous question, I asked all my colleagues in the UC, in the [department redacted], the colleagues that are doing like mobile work in different topics like nationalism and violence and things like that, racial violence and so, I asked them, would you suggest an article, would you suggest this is a good article or a bad article so, that I can include it in my class. And then asking my colleagues and having the help of the students to redesign the course has been great. And this is only because I got the funding from the [conference name redacted].

I: Very nice. I was very lucky to be able to participate a bit in the [institute name redacted] as well. It was really, I thought, really well put together week-long exercise for folks to do so, I was glad to see it myself.

UCSB07: Yeah I really liked it.

I: I'm going to go ahead and stop the recording since that is the final question.